

How to Present the Isaac AI Capability Framework

The Problem: You have a comprehensive framework mapping Isaac's 8 capabilities + 7 gaps + policy alignment. But how do you *make it matter* to different audiences without overwhelming them?

The Solution: Three distinct narratives + one evidence structure.

PART 1: NARRATIVE ARCS BY AUDIENCE

AUDIENCE 1: Architecture Review Board (ARB)

Your narrative arc:

"We've analyzed 15 months of GC policy signals (DADM, GC AI Strategy, HC AI mandate) and mapped them against Isaac's capability framework. We found 3 non-negotiable gaps that, if unfixed, make DADM compliance impossible. Here's how we close them and why Isaac v2.4 must include all 16 capabilities."

Slide sequence:

1. **Problem:** "Isaac's 8 capabilities don't cover DADM §3.2 (explanation), §2.2 (bias), or §5 (change control)"
2. **Impact:** "Without these, PATH/HAIL cannot deploy any high-risk AI to production"
3. **Solution:** "Add 7 capabilities that close GC policy gaps (mapped to DADM § + principles)"
4. **Evidence:** "Every capability ties to a specific policy authority (DADM, ISO 42001, HC strategy)"
5. **Outcome:** "16-capability framework = DADM-compliant, GC-aligned, HC-strategic"

Key stat to lead with:

"3 capabilities are DADM-mandatory (Explainability, Bias Testing, Model Management). Without them, we cannot get ARB approval for any decision-touching AI."

What ARB cares about: Policy defensibility, compliance, risk tiering, executive accountability.

AUDIENCE 2: Isaac (the capability framework owner)

Your narrative arc:

"Your v2.3 framework is solid but incomplete from a GC policy perspective. Here are the 7 gaps that TBS, PSPC, and SSC are implicitly requiring. Including them in v2.4 makes Isaac the reference model for federal AI, not just health AI."

Slide sequence:

1. **Context:** "GC AI Principles + DADM + HC strategy create an implicit policy demand for capabilities you didn't explicitly name"
2. **Gaps:** "PSPC signals Model Management; TBS signals Explainability; SSC signals Data Privacy"
3. **Opportunity:** "If Isaac includes all 16, it becomes THE federal AI capability taxonomy"
4. **Evidence:** "Each gap is signaled by at least 2 GC organizations (TBS, PSPC, SSC, ISO standards)"
5. **Outcome:** "v2.4 = policy-informed, stakeholder-validated, market-ready"

Key stat to lead with:

"7 capabilities you didn't explicitly include are signaled by TBS, PSPC, ISO 42001, and HC/PHAC EA. Adding them makes v2.4 compliant with GC's implicit requirements."

What Isaac cares about: Market alignment, vendor competitiveness, federal relevance, adoption.

AUDIENCE 3: Health Canada CDO / ADM leadership

Your narrative arc:

"Our enterprise AI platform (PATH/HAIL) must align to three things: GC policy (DADM), federal procurement (PSPC capability expectations), and HC's strategic mandates. This framework shows how we do all three simultaneously."

Slide sequence:

1. **Strategic:** "HC AI Strategy has 3 focus areas (Empower, Surveillance, Regulatory). All 16 capabilities align to at least one."
2. **Governance:** "DADM compliance isn't optional. We've mapped every capability to the

specific § it triggers.”

3. **Platform:** “PATH/HAIL must provide all 16 capabilities as enterprise services. Here’s what that means operationally.”
4. **Risk:** “Without these capabilities, we have compliance gaps. With them, we have a defensible AI governance model.”
5. **Outcome:** “Enterprise AI platform that meets GC policy + HC strategy + ADM accountability”

Key stat to lead with:

“Every AI system PATH/HAIL hosts must satisfy DADM §2.2 (data), §3.1–3.3 (decisions), or §5 (controls). This framework ensures we design for those requirements, not retrofit them.”

What CDO/ADM cares about: Strategic alignment, compliance, governance accountability, enterprise capability.

AUDIENCE 4: PSPC (supplier/procurement side)

Your narrative arc:

“You’re looking for AI suppliers who understand GC capability taxonomy and can deliver to specific, measurable specifications. This framework is that spec sheet. Every capability has a governance gate.”

Slide sequence:

1. **Procurement:** “PSPC needs vendors who declare capabilities + SLAs. This framework defines what ‘Generative AI’ actually means in GC context.”
2. **Specs:** “Each of 16 capabilities has explicit sub-capabilities, governance requirements, and integration specs.”
3. **Quality:** “Governance gates ensure vendors test for DADM compliance, fairness, explainability, etc. before sale.”
4. **Evidence:** “Every capability traces to a TBS/PSPC/ISO requirement.”
5. **Outcome:** “Capability-driven procurement: you buy measured, verified capabilities, not black boxes”

Key stat to lead with:

“16 capabilities with explicit governance gates = a procurement spec that PSPC can use

to evaluate all AI vendors against the same 16-point framework."

What PSPC cares about: Vendor evaluation, capability definition, compliance verification, procurement efficiency.

PART 2: THE EVIDENCE STRUCTURE (Same for all audiences)

You show them **5 things**:

1. DADM Alignment (§-by-§ mapping)

Isaac Capability → DADM § → Governance Gate → ARB Checkmark

Example:

Decision Support AI → §3.1 (CORE) → Mandatory AIA + Audit trail + Appeal procedure
Explainability → §3.2 (CORE) → LIME/SHAP testing + Citizen disclosure → Compliant
Bias & Fairness → §2.2 (CORE) → Demographic parity analysis + Continuous monitoring

Why this matters: ARB cannot approve an AI platform that doesn't satisfy DADM. This shows you've thought about it at the § level.

2. GC Principle Cross-reference

Capability → Principles #1, #5, #7, #9 (mapped)

Why this matters: Shows you understand that policy is multi-dimensional, not single-issue.

3. HC AI Strategy Alignment

Capability → Focus Area (Workforce / Surveillance / Regulatory) → Enabling Pillar

Example:

Real-time & Streaming AI → Scale & Strengthen Surveillance → Data & Technology +

Why this matters: Shows how enterprise AI supports HC's strategic mandates (not just IT

projects).

4. Maturity Staging

Stage 1 (Experimental) → Stage 2 (Operational) → Stage 3 (Enterprise) → Stage 4 (

Why this matters: Shows you have a path from pilot to enterprise without governance cliff.

5. Policy Authority Traceability

Gap 1.1 (Model Management) ← PSPC + HC/PHAC EA + ISO 42001 § 5.4

Gap 1.2 (Explainability) ← TBS ADM § 3.2 + EU AI Act + ISO 42001 § 5.3.5

Gap 1.3 (Bias Testing) ← NIST RMF + EU AI Act + ISO 42001 § 5.3.3

Why this matters: Every gap is justified by outside authority, not your opinion.

PART 3: DECISION TREES — How to Use This Framework

Decision Tree 1: "Should we add [capability] to PATH v1?"

Does the capability touch:

- | Automated decisions? → Yes → Does DADM apply? → Yes → Is it §2.2, §3.1-3.3, or
- | Protected data (B/C)? → Yes → Does §2.2 apply? → Yes → Privacy/bias controls r
- | Citizen-facing services? → Yes → Is explanation required? → Yes → Add to v1
- | Otherwise → Evaluate: Is it signaled by 2+ GC orgs? → If yes, prioritize for v

Decision Tree 2: "Is this capability ARB-defensible?"

Capability has:

- | DADM mapping? ✓ → Go to next
 - | GC Principle mapping? ✓ → Go to next
 - | HC Strategy alignment? ✓ → Go to next
 - | Governance gate defined? ✓ → Go to next
 - | All 4? → ARB-defensible
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Decision Tree 3: “What’s the minimum viable PATH v1?”

Capabilities that MUST be in v1 (DADM-mandatory):

- └ Explainability & Interpretability (§3.2)
- └ Bias & Fairness Testing (§2.2)
- └ AI Model Management (§5)
- └ Enterprise AI Integration (§5)
- └ Decision Support AI + Auditability (§3.1)

Capabilities that SHOULD be in v1 (High risk + HC priority):

- └ Predictive AI (Surveillance)
- └ Classification AI (Regulatory)
- └ Real-time & Streaming AI (Surveillance)
- └ Data Privacy & Isolation (Protected B)

Capabilities that CAN be v1.5 (Medium priority):

- └ Generative AI (once Explainability is live)
- └ Knowledge AI (enterprise reuse, not mandatory)
- └ Conversational AI (internal, lower risk)
- └ Perception AI (Structured & Unstructured)

PART 4: HOW TO DEFEND YOURSELF AGAINST CHALLENGES

Challenge 1: “Why do we need 16 capabilities? Isn’t 8 enough?”

Your response:

“DADM compliance requires 5 capabilities Isaac didn’t name (Explainability, Bias, Model Management, Integration, Real-time). PSPC, SSC, and HC/PHAC EA signal 2 more (Data Privacy, Robustness). That’s 15 right there, plus management. Each is justified by GC policy, not our preference.”

Evidence: Point to the DADM § mapping sheet. Show them §3.2 (explanation), §2.2 (bias), §5 (model management) are mandatory.

Challenge 2: “Explainability & Bias Testing aren’t capabilities; they’re controls.”

Your response:

“They’re both. As governance controls, yes. But as *reusable platform services that every program can leverage*, they’re capabilities. PATH must offer Explainability-as-a-Service

(LIME/SHAP pipelines) and Bias-Testing-as-a-Service (demographic parity analysis). If programs have to build these separately, we have fragmentation."

Evidence: ISO 42001 treats these as capability enablers, not just controls. So does NIST AI RMF.

Challenge 3: "This is too comprehensive. We should start simple."

Your response:

"You're right — we should start simple. But 'simple' can't mean 'non-compliant.' The 5 DADM-mandatory capabilities are non-negotiable for v1. Everything else can be phased. Here's the phasing: v1 = DADM-core (5 capabilities) + HC Strategic (2 capabilities). v1.5 = Everyone else. That's defensible to ARB."

Evidence: Point to the "Capability Progression" sheet. Show Stage 1–2 vs. Stage 3–5 separation.

Challenge 4: "Other departments don't have this level of detail. Why us?"

Your response:

"Because HC/PHAC operates under DADM (TBS mandatory), EU AI Act compliance (August 2026), and regulated health data (Protected B). Other departments have simpler use cases. We don't have that luxury. Our detail is justified by our constraints."

Evidence: Show the "GC Influencers" sheet. Point out TBS (mandatory), PSPC (procurement), SSC (infrastructure), EU Act (compliance deadline).

PART 5: ONE-PAGER FOR EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Title: "Isaac v2.4: 8 → 16 Capabilities (Policy-Driven Expansion)"

The ask:

- Accept 16-capability framework (not 8)
- Prioritize 5 DADM-mandatory capabilities for PATH v1
- Phase remaining 11 by HC strategic priority

Why now:

- DADM compliance is non-negotiable (TBS mandate)
- EU AI Act deadline: August 2026
- PATH/HAIL v1 cannot launch without these controls

Evidence:

- 5 gaps are DADM §2.2, §3.1-3.3, §5 requirements
- 7 gaps signaled by TBS, PSPC, SSC, HC/PHAC EA
- All 16 align to HC AI Strategy focus areas + enabling pillars

What success looks like:

- ARB approves 16-capability framework by [date]
- PATH v1 delivers 5 DADM-mandatory capabilities
- Procurement specs align to 16-capability model

Risk if we don't:

- DADM compliance gaps = ARB rejection
- Fragmented AI procurement (no shared specs)
- Repeated builds instead of platform reuse

PART 6: SPECIFIC TALKING POINTS BY STAKEHOLDER

For ARB:

- "We've mapped Isaac against DADM § to ensure policy defensibility."
- "3 capabilities are DADM-mandatory; without them, PATH cannot get ATO."
- "16 capabilities cover all GC Influencers (TBS, PSPC, SSC) + ISO standards."

For Isaac:

- "Your v2.3 is the foundation. v2.4 adds the 7 gaps that GC policy implicitly requires."
- "This makes Isaac THE federal reference model, not just health AI."

For CDO/ADM:

- "PATH/HAIL must satisfy DADM, HC Strategy, and ADM accountability. This framework does all 3."
- "Every governance gate ties back to policy § or GC organization, not our opinion."

For PSPC:

- "This is the spec sheet vendors must meet to sell to GC."
 - "16 capabilities = 16-point evaluation framework for all AI vendors."
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FINAL PRESENTATION CHECKLIST

- Lead with the **problem** (8 ≠ compliant)
 - Show the **evidence** (DADM § mapping + GC signals)
 - Propose **phased solution** (v1 = mandatory + strategic; v1.5 = everything else)
 - Prove **alignment** (DADM + GC Principles + HC Strategy)
 - Defend against **challenges** (with evidence from the sheet)
 - End with **one clear ask** (ARB approval, Isaac adoption, PATH prioritization)
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The story is not "Here's a 16-capability framework."

The story is: "DADM compliance requires 16 capabilities. Here's how they align to GC policy + HC strategy + ARB requirements, and here's how we phase them responsibly."

That's how you **make this out** — not as an academic exercise, but as a policy-driven, evidence-based architectural decision.